

questioning has to be taken off your credit report until they can prove that it belongs there.

If you have errors bringing down your score, in 30 days they're gone and your credit has gone from bad to good! In 30 days!

Ed Did

Ed's credit report showed that he had an Old Navy credit card, yet never in his life did he ever have an Old Navy credit card account. Sue closed her Discover card three years ago, and it still showed as an open account. Perhaps when you review yours, you will find that there is a judgment listed against you that simply does not belong to you. These are the types of items to get corrected.

Ed discovered the same error on all three credit reports, so he initiated a dispute with all three credit reporting agencies. He also could have contacted the creditor directly to make the correction and report it to the credit reporting agencies. Ed initiated the disputes online, the most time-efficient way to go. Each credit reporting agency website had prompts to follow that easily guided Ed through the process.

Personal Statement

If you want to explain negative information on your credit report that is legit, and not an error, you can add a "Personal Statement" to your credit reports. Your comments don't impact your credit score, but will be read by anyone reviewing your credit. Whether it will affect the interest rate they give you is highly doubtful.

Ed and Sue used this opportunity to explain that their house payments had been late because they had paid for their son's medical bills. As soon as that debt was taken care of, the house payments were timely again. Perhaps you were late on your car payment because you lost your job. Or you had collection action taken against you on an account because you were unable to pay when you had a medical emergency or a sudden illness.

The Personal Statement has to be short – 100 words or less. If the negative item is later removed, your Personal Statement does not